

REFUND AND RETURN POLICY

Last updated: January 2025

OVERVIEW

We want you to be completely satisfied with your purchase. If something is not right, we will work to make it right. This policy explains how to initiate a return, which items are eligible, how refunds are processed, and what to expect at every step.

1. RETURN ELIGIBILITY

1.1 Standard Return Window

Most items can be returned within 30 days of the delivery date. Items must be:

- In their original, unused condition
- In the original packaging with all tags, accessories, and documentation included
- Free from damage caused by the customer

1.2 Extended Return Window

We offer an extended 60-day return window for:

- Items purchased during major sale events (Black Friday, Cyber Monday, holiday promotions)
- Orders placed by verified members of our loyalty program at Gold tier or above
- Items marked "Extended Returns Eligible" on the product page

1.3 Non-Returnable Items

The following cannot be returned:

- Digital downloads and software license keys once activated or downloaded
- Gift cards and store credit
- Perishable goods (food, flowers, live plants)
- Hazardous materials and flammable liquids
- Custom or personalized items (engraved, monogrammed, made-to-order)
- Intimate apparel, swimwear, and pierced jewelry for hygiene reasons (unless defective)
- Items marked "Final Sale" at the time of purchase
- Opened consumable products (cosmetics, supplements, batteries)

1.4 Partial Returns

You may return individual items from a multi-item order. Refunds are calculated per item based on the price paid, minus any applicable restocking fees or proportional discounts applied to the order.

2. HOW TO INITIATE A RETURN

2.1 Online Return Portal

The fastest way to start a return is through our self-service portal:

1. Log into your account and go to Order History
2. Select the order and click "Return or Exchange"
3. Choose the item(s) you wish to return and select a reason
4. Select whether you prefer a refund or an exchange
5. Print the prepaid return shipping label (if eligible) or choose to ship at your own cost
6. Pack the item securely and drop it off at the indicated carrier location

2.2 Guest Orders

If you checked out as a guest, initiate your return by emailing support@shopexample.com with your order number, the item(s) to return, and your reason. We will send you instructions within 1 business day.

2.3 In-Store Returns

If you purchased online, you may return eligible items at any of our physical store locations. Bring the item with its original packaging and your order confirmation email or receipt. In-store returns are refunded to the original payment method within 5 business days.

3. RETURN SHIPPING

3.1 Free Returns (Defective or Our Error)

If you received a defective item, a wrong item, or your order was damaged in transit, we will provide a prepaid return label at no cost to you.

3.2 Customer-Initiated Returns

For change-of-mind returns, we offer a prepaid label for a \$6.99 deduction from your refund, or you may ship at your own expense using any carrier. If you ship at your own expense, use a service with tracking and retain your receipt ? we are not responsible for packages lost during return transit.

3.3 International Returns

Customers outside the United States are responsible for all return shipping costs and any duties or taxes associated with the return. We do not provide prepaid international return labels.

3.4 Return Shipment Requirements

- Use a sturdy box; do not use the product box alone as the outer shipping box
- Include a copy of your packing slip or a note with your order number inside
- Do not write on or attach labels directly to the product's retail packaging

4. REFUND PROCESSING

4.1 Inspection Period

Once we receive your return, our team inspects it within 2 to 3 business days. You will receive an email confirming receipt and the inspection outcome.

4.2 Approved Refunds

Approved refunds are issued within 3 to 5 business days of inspection approval. The refund is returned to the original payment method used at checkout. This means:

- Credit or debit card: 3 to 10 business days to appear depending on your bank
- PayPal: 3 to 5 business days
- Store credit: applied immediately to your account
- Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) plans: handled in accordance with the BNPL provider's refund policy

4.3 Partial Refunds

We may issue a partial refund (typically 15 to 25% less than the original price) for items that:

- Are returned without original packaging
- Show signs of use that reduce resale value
- Are missing accessories or documentation that was included at original sale

4.4 Denied Refunds

Refunds may be denied if:

- The item is clearly used beyond reasonable inspection
- The item does not match what was purchased (wrong item sent back)
- The return window has expired
- The item falls under a non-returnable category

You will be notified by email if your return is denied. Denied items can be shipped back to you at your expense.

4.5 Restocking Fees

A restocking fee of 15% applies to:

- Electronics returned after 15 days from delivery
- Large furniture and appliances
- Special-order items not normally stocked

=====

5. EXCHANGES

=====

5.1 How to Exchange

Select "Exchange" when initiating your return in the portal. Choose the replacement item (same product in a different size/color, or a different product). If the replacement costs more, you will be charged the difference. If it costs less, the difference is refunded to your original payment method.

5.2 Exchange Shipping

Standard exchanges ship free via standard shipping once we receive and inspect your returned item. If you need the replacement faster, select expedited shipping at checkout (additional fee applies).

5.3 Exchange Eligibility

Exchanges follow the same eligibility rules as returns. Non-returnable items cannot be exchanged.

=====

6. DEFECTIVE AND DAMAGED ITEMS

=====

6.1 Item Arrived Defective

If your item was defective on arrival, contact us within 30 days of delivery. We will offer:

- A full replacement shipped at no cost
- A full refund with a prepaid return label
- A repair or service credit, where applicable

6.2 Damage in Transit

Report transit damage within 7 days of delivery. Include photos of the outer packaging and the damaged item. We will file a carrier claim and issue a replacement or refund once the claim is processed (typically 5 to 10 business days).

6.3 Manufacturer Defects After Use

Defects that appear during normal use after delivery may be covered by the manufacturer's warranty rather than our return policy. See the Product Warranty Policy or the documentation included with your item for warranty details. We can assist in connecting you with the manufacturer.

=====

7. ORDER CANCELLATIONS

=====

7.1 Before Shipment

Orders can be cancelled at no charge if they have not yet entered the processing or fulfillment stage. Go to Order History and click "Cancel Order" to request cancellation. If eligible, the full amount is refunded to the original payment method within 3 to 5 business days.

7.2 After Shipment

Once an order has shipped, it cannot be cancelled. You will need to wait for delivery and then initiate a return following the standard process.

7.3 Pre-order Cancellations

Pre-orders can be cancelled at any time before the estimated ship date for a full refund.

=====

8. GIFT RETURNS

=====

If you received an item as a gift and need to return it, contact our support team with the order number (found on the packing slip). You can choose to receive store credit in the amount of the item's original price. Store credit can be used immediately and does not expire.

=====

9. FRAUD PREVENTION

=====

We monitor return activity to protect against abuse. Customers with a history of excessive returns, fraudulent claims, or returning items not purchased from us may have their return privileges restricted. We reserve the right to refuse returns that violate our policy.

=====

10. CONTACT FOR RETURN ISSUES

=====

Our support team is available to help with any return or refund concern via live chat Monday through Friday 9 AM to 6 PM, by email at returns@shopexample.com, or by phone at 1-800-555-0199.